

Easter

April 20, 2025

9:00 A.M.





Minnehaha United Methodist Church

A Reconciling Congregation

We Seek. We Serve. We Celebrate.

Welcome Friends!

We welcome you to worship wherever you may be in your faith's journey. We strive to live in the way of Jesus Christ, sharing God's love on a daily basis regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history.

We livestream our worship services, and you may end up in view of the camera at any point in the service.

Worship Personnel

Rev. Becky Sechrist, *Pastor*;
Rev. Jean Elliott, *Director of Children, Youth, & Their Families*;
Anders Nelson, *Organist*;
Tim Siefkes, *Band Leader*;
Cindy Bergstrom, *Choir Director*;
Nicholas and Patience Sabah, *Communion Stewards*

Minnehaha United Methodist Church acknowledges that we gather on the traditional, ancestral, and contemporary land of Dakota People.

Attendance

We are delighted you are here! We invite you to "sign the welcome pad" electronically.

If you point your camera phone at the QR code, it will take you to a Google form where you can enter your information.



Offering

For our offering, you can also give electronically through the PayPal account online, or by using this QR Code (which takes you to our PayPal account).



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April 20, 2025 9:00 a.m.

* Please rise in body or spirit

Children in Worship

We always welcome children in worship! We assume that they may make noise, wriggle, and even run around. The worship service is also live-streamed into the nursery. In addition, we have activity bags for children and big kid activity boxes (2nd grade & older) at the back of the sanctuary. Rocking chairs are also available for nursing or rocking at the back of the sanctuary and in the 2nd floor nursery.

Prelude

Anders Nelson, *organist*

Prelude in C

"Little" Prelude and Fugue in Bb

J.S. Bach

Welcome

*Call to Worship

(adapted from Sarah Speed, A Sanctified Art LLC, sanctifiedart.org.)

Leader: This day is not like any other day.

People: Today we slow down.

Today we take it all in.

Today we rest in good news.

Leader: This day is not like any other day.

People: Today we are singing.

Today we are full to the brim.

Today joy cannot be contained.

Leader: This day is not like any other day.

People: Today the stone was rolled away.

Today the women saw the empty grave.

Today we know—death does not win.

Leader: This day is not like any other day.

People: Alleluia! Amen.

***Opening Hymn** *Christ the Lord is Risen Today* #302, vv. 1-4

The United Methodist hymnal (red)

Charles Wesley (1739)

Children's Message

Rev. Jean Elliott

Sharing the Peace of Christ

Sharing of Joys & Concerns

Morning Prayer

(adapted from Sarah Speed, A Sanctified Art LLC, sanctifiedart.org)

Holy God, we so often long for more. We want more than the hamster wheel life of to-do lists and errands, meal prep and alarm clocks.

We want more than comparison and competition.

We want more than certainty that drowns out curiosity.

We want more than fear that leads to violence.

We want a life that is teeming with alleluias.

We want a life overcrowded with hope.

We want a life congested with good news.

We want a life jam-packed with forgiveness.

We want a life bursting with laughter.

We want a life so full that the stone just has to be rolled away.

So today we pray— break the dam. Dust the cobwebs from our ears. Clear space in our minds to hear you clearly. Speak to us as only you can. It's what we long for. We long for you. Gratefully we pray, Amen.

Silent Prayer

Pastoral Prayer

The Lord's Prayer

inclusive

**Our Creator, God in heaven,
hallowed be thy name.
Thy kin-dom^{*} come, thy will be done,
on earth as it is in heaven.
Give us this day our daily bread.
And forgive us our trespasses as we forgive
those who trespass against us.
Lead us not into temptation,
but deliver us from evil.
For thine is the kin-dom and the power
and the glory forever. *Amen.***

^{*}*Kin-dom represents a hope for God's realm where we are all in community with one another.*

Choral Anthem

Jesus Christ, the Lord of Joy

Paul Bouman

Jesus Christ, the Lord of Joy,
Now from death's deep dungeon risen,
Lets the Church His praise employ,
Sets her free from sorrow's prison.
Death did all its strengths deploy,
Jesus lives, the Lord of Joy.

To the Maker in His death
Jesus went with will unswerving,
Giving up life's precious breath
For His people undeserving.
He whom death could not destroy
Lives to be the Church's Joy.

Sorrow here a little while;
Suffer midst the world's rejoicing,
Satan's arts through us beguile;
World and flesh our joys are voicing,
These deceive like base alloy,
Jesus Christ, the Church's Joy.

Now take heart, you Christian friends,
Fill God's house with loud thanksgiving,
Jesus lives to come again,
Joy for anguish to be giving.
Pain and trials now annoy,
Jesus comes, the Church's Joy!

Alleluia, risen Lord!
Jesus Christ, the Church's Joy!

~ Raymond Schulze

Scripture Lesson

Luke 24:1-12

Clara Sandager

***Hymn**

The United Methodist hymnal (red)

Easter People, Raise Your Voices #304

William M. James, Henry T. Smart © 1979 The United Methodist Publishing House

Sermon

"An Expansive Life"

Rev. Becky Sechrist

Offering of Gifts and Tithes

Offertory

Martha Bentley, *horn*; Marshall Cook, *euphonium*; Paul Nation, *trumpet*; Annie Strom, *flute*;
Siri Strom & Eric Strom, *percussion*; Michael Talcott, *trumpet*; Anders Nelson, *piano*

Christ Arose

Dana F. Everson

***Act of Praise**

The United Methodist Hymnal (red)

Doxology #94

Thomas Ken (1674) Ralph Vaughan Williams (1906)

***Prayer of Dedication**

We dedicate this offering and all our resources to drying tears and sharing good news of peace. Make us instruments of healing and channels of forgiveness so all your people may realize opportunities for new life. We rejoice in the promise of salvation that we are privileged to share. Amen.

Affirmation of Faith

(adapted from Sarah Speed, A Sanctified Art LLC, sanctifiedart.org)

We believe in a God who can astound us—a God who created the mountains of Colorado, the stars on a summer night, and the green of Ireland. We believe in Jesus, whose example changes us—an example of love for those on the fringes, healing for the sick, and welcome for the lonely. We believe that Jesus was abandoned by his friends, wounded, mocked, and killed by the state. And in a garden, three days later, we believe that life began again—

the stone was rolled back, as death lost its sting. Ever since that day, we believe the Spirit has been inviting us into an expansive life—a life not measured by wealth or accolades, but a life full to the brim with joy, overflowing with laughter, saturated in hope, and decorated with good news.

Death has lost its sting.

We believe, and are set free.

Thanks be to God. Amen.

Announcements

***Closing Hymn**

Hallelujah Chorus

George Frideric Handel (1741)

Hallelujah! Hallelujah! Hallelujah! Hallelujah! Hallelujah!

For the Lord God Omnipotent reigneth.

Hallelujah! Hallelujah! Hallelujah! Hallelujah!

For the Lord God omnipotent reigneth.

Hallelujah! Hallelujah! Hallelujah! Hallelujah! Hallelujah! Hallelujah! Hallelujah!

The kingdom of this world

Is become the kingdom of our Lord,

And of His Christ, and of His Christ;

And He shall reign for ever and ever,

For ever and ever, forever and ever,

King of kings, and Lord of lords,

King of kings, and Lord of lords,

And Lord of lords,

And He shall reign,

And He shall reign forever and ever,

King of kings, forever and ever,

And Lord of lords,

Hallelujah! Hallelujah!

And He shall reign forever and ever,

King of kings! and Lord of lords!

And He shall reign forever and ever,

King of kings! and Lord of lords!

Hallelujah! Hallelujah! Hallelujah! Hallelujah!

Hallelujah!

Benediction

Postlude

Minuet Gothique

Leon Boellmann

In Our Prayers

WELCOME TO ALL VISITING THIS EASTER SUNDAY!

We're so glad you're here. If you're seeking a church that feels like "home", we hope you'll consider Minnehaha United Methodist Church. We are a thriving multi-generational, multi-cultural congregation. Our Christian faith drives us to take action in our neighborhood through local missions, activism, and sharing the unconditional love of God with our neighbors. We work to make good things happen in our wider community.

We think you will find ours a community that has a lot to offer:

- A place where **everyone is welcome**;
- Faith development in a **positive, non-judgmental** way;
- **Meaningful worship** with varied music and two different Sunday morning worship services;
- A **dynamic children's program** and a strong, multi-faceted program for teens, with support for parents;
- Numerous opportunities for **service to others**;
- The opportunity for close, **life-long friendships**.

To find out more, visit our website (www.minnehaha.org) or contact our pastor, Becky Sechrist (becky@minnehaha.org). Thank you for your visit. We hope you'll come back soon. Our worship services are normally at 9:30 on Sundays, and we alternate our music styles between our band and the choir and organ. In the summer, we worship outside in our side lawn – our first worship service outside will be on May 24 at 10:00 a.m.

Holding in prayer:

- **Hospice:** Darci Siefkes
- **Receiving treatment for cancer:** Zobeida Bonilla, Jim Duncan (Linda Duncan's husband), Judy Durfey, George Gallagher (Food Shelf Director)

We are looking for Scripture Readers

Children, Teens & Adults are encouraged & welcome to sign up!

Annette Meier will send the scripture to you on Wednesday - if you don't hear from her, or you sign up later than Wednesday, please text/call her (612) 597-1778 or e-mail at salmeier@hotmail.com
Here is the link to the sign-up tool:



THIS WEEK AT MINNEHAHA

Sunday Apr 20, 2025 Easter

- 7a Sunrise Service (Sanctuary)
- 9a Worship with Choir and Organ (Sanctuary)
- 10a Egg Hunt (2nd floor & 3rd floor)
- 11a Worship with Band (Sanctuary)
- 4p Rehearsal Mpls Choir Co-Op (Sanctuary)
- 7p SAA (306)

Monday Apr 21, 2025

- 1:30p Al-Anon (306)
- 6:30p Executive Team (210)
- 6:30p Soul Group (Zoom 3)
- 6:30p Troop Meeting (Fellowship Hall & Gym)

Tuesday Apr 22, 2025

- 9a Fun & Fitness Group (302/304)
- 10a Food Shelf (Fellowship Hall, Narthex)
- 2p Book of Revelation (210)
- 6p Karate Group (Gym)
- 6:30p SPR (Zoom 1, 210)

Wednesday Apr 23, 2025

- 9:10a Men's Study of Scripture + Prophetic Consciousness (210)
- 5:30p Methodicals (Wesley Room)
- 5:30p Wednesday Night Dinner (Fellowship Hall and Kitchen)
- 6p Wednesday Night Childcare (Gym, 202, 204)
- 6:15p Chancel Choir (310)
- 6:15p Children's Council (210)
- 6:15p Confirmation (302/304)
- 6:15p Joseph rehearsal (Sanctuary)

Thursday Apr 24, 2025

- 9a Fun & Fitness Group (302/304)
- 9:30a Minnehaha Playgroup (202/204, (Gym until 10:45))
- 12p MinneHarvest Delivery
- 6p Karate Group (Gym)
- 6:30p Trustees (Zoom)

Friday Apr 25, 2025

- 10a Al-Anon (306)
- 6:30p RCA (306)

Saturday Apr 26, 2025

- 7a MinneHarvest (Narthex, Outside)
- 9a M. Mazvydas Lithuanian Heritage School (Narthex, 206, 208, 302, 304, 306, 308, 310)
- 11a Karate Group (Gym)

Sunday Apr 27, 2025

- 9:30a Worship with Organ and Choir (Sanctuary)
- 10:45a Adult Faith Formation (310)
- 10:45a Sunday School (Classrooms)
- 12p PUGA Dance Group (Gym)
- 1p Joseph rehearsal (Sanctuary)
- 4p Youth Groups (302/304 & 308, Gym)
- 6p Rehearsal Mpls Choir Co-Op (Sanctuary)
- 6:30p Togolese Community Church (Fellowship Hall)
- 7p SAA (306)

OUR EASTER GARDEN IS GIVEN TODAY BY:

In honor of Hassan, Guljeen, & Ronak Barzani
by Hassan Barzani.

In memory of Dinah Amundrud and Roger Beck
by the Beck Family.

For our parents by Marshall & Margaret Cook.

In memory of Donn by Wanda Driver.

From Linda & Jim Duncan.

In memory of beloved family by Sarah Hicks.

In celebration of friends and family by Arlo & Susan Johnson.

In memory of loved ones and in celebration of Easter
by Char & Craig Johnson.

In memory of Brad Hanson by Dan & Becky Johnson.

In celebration of friends and family by Peter & Sue Johnson.

For peace in the world, peace in my soul by Margaret Rawson.

In memory of Joan Ellison and of Bob & Barb Ellison
by Patricia Roth.

In memory of Thomas Brossart and in celebration of Sue
Ammerman by Kristin Southworth.



Minnehaha Compassion Camp Day with the Summer Fairy

Register online at minnehaha.org



The Minneapolis Choir Co-op is partnering with the East Phillips Neighborhood Institute for a special Earth Day Concert. The concert will be on April 26 at 6pm at Mount Olive Lutheran Church. 3045 Chicago Ave. Minneapolis MN. Tickets may be purchased using this link:

zeffy.com/ticketing/42625-missa-gaia





Joseph and the Amazing Technicolor Dreamcoat

Sunday, May 4
during 9:30am Worship

Way, way back in 1968, Tim Rice and Andrew Lloyd Weber were commissioned by Colet Court School to write a short musical for the whole school to perform. It was their first collaboration, and a 22 minute version of *Joseph and the Amazing Technicolor Dreamcoat* was the result.

Parents loved it, and demanded a repeat performance where they could invite more guests, and so folks were invited to Methodist Central Hall at Westminster. By 1973, this musical had been developed into the full length musical that many of us are familiar with today.

On Sunday, May 4, in the Minnehaha United Methodist Central Hall (aka the Sanctuary) we will present to you the original 22 minute version of *Joseph* as a part of our worship service. There's wonderful, upbeat music, a dazzling coat of many colors, a hairy bunch of Ishmaelites, talented Minnehaha youth and children and adults, and a message of forgiveness and persistence and dreaming. We hope to see you there!



Wednesday Night
Dinner

5:30-6:15 PM

**ROASTED CHICKEN
DINNER**

COST: \$5/PERSON;
\$20/FAMILY